PHILOSOPHY PAPER II — PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION 01 — NOTIONS OF GOD

CONTROL QUESTION AND CONCEPTUAL → WESTERN RELATION MODELS → DIVINE ATTRIBUTES UNDER COHERENCE → SPINOZA: DEUS SIVE NATURA → ADVAITA: NIRGUṆA, SAGUṆA AND → RĀMĀNUJA: ORGANIC UNITY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ★ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g13 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

00

STAGE 00 CONTROL QUESTION AND CONCEPTUAL AXES

CONTROL QUESTION AND CONCEPTUAL AXES · NOTIONS OF GOD · WHAT KIND OF REALITY IS CALLED "GOD", AND HOW · TRANSPERSONAL ATTRIBUTES · SIMPLICITY RELATION · NATURE AXIS · PERSONAL <–> IMPERSONAL · RELATION AXIS

NOTIONS OF GOD

What kind of reality is called "God", and how is it related to man and → nature: personal / impersonal / transpersonal attributes: power / knowledge / goodness / eternity / → / God-man / transcendence / immanence

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NOTIONS OF GOD
- What kind of reality is called "God", and how is it related to man and the world?
- nature: personal / impersonal / transpersonal attributes: power / knowledge / goodness / eternity / simplicity relation: God-world

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- / God-man / transcendence / immanence
- NATURE AXIS: personal <–> impersonal
- RELATION AXIS: transcendent <–> immanent cataphatic affirmation + apophatic negation → analogical control too much affirmation = anthropomorphism

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- too much negation = empty God-talk.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Personal/impersonal and transcendent/immanent are independent analytical axes; do not turn them into bodily/spatial claims.

01

STAGE 01 WESTERN RELATION MODELS

WESTERN RELATION MODELS · WESTERN NOTIONS · PERSONAL NECESSARY CREATOR; DISTINCT, SUSTAINING, PROVIDENTIAL · NATURAL LAW · WITHDRAWAL; MIRACLES/REVELATION WEAKENED · WORLD IS IN GOD, BUT GOD EXCEEDS WORLD · PROCESS/DIPOLAR GOD ABSTRACT POLE · ETERNAL POSSIBILITIES + STABLE CHARACTER CONSEQUENT POLE

WESTERN NOTIONS

THEISM: personal necessary Creator; distinct, sustaining, providential → DEISM: creation → natural law → withdrawal; miracles/revelation weakened → PANTHEISM: God = world/nature

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- WESTERN NOTIONS
- THEISM: personal necessary Creator; distinct, sustaining, providential
- DEISM: creation → natural law → withdrawal; miracles/revelation weakened

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- PANTHEISM: God = world/nature
- PANENTHEISM: world is in God, but God exceeds world
- PROCESS/DIPOLAR GOD abstract pole: eternal possibilities + stable character consequent pole: receives changing world and experience persuasion protects

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- freedom, but revises omnipotence and immutability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Doctrine statement. God is a necessary, personal creator, distinct from yet continuously sustaining the world, traditionally described as omnipotent, omniscient, perfectly good, eternal, immutable and simple.

02

STAGE 02 DIVINE ATTRIBUTES UNDER COHERENCE PRESSURE

DIVINE ATTRIBUTES UNDER COHERENCE PRESSURE · ETERNITY IMMUTABILITY · ASEITY OMNIPOTENCE · LOGICALLY POSSIBLE ACTS; CONTRADICTIONS ARE NOT OBJECTS OF POWER · OPEN THEISM GOODNESS + POWER + KNOWLEDGE + EVIL · JOINT COMPATIBILITY PRESSURE SIMPLICITY · NO PARTS; ESSENCE · EXISTENCE; ATTRIBUTES NOT SEPARABLE COMPONENTS OBJECTION

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
ATTRIBUTES: omnipotence	aseity omnipotence → logically possible acts; contradictions are not objects of power foreknowledge vs freedom → Boethius	essence = existence
eternity immutability	open theism goodness + power + knowledge + evil → joint compatibility pressure simplicity → no parts	attributes not separable components objection: can identical attributes permit free, personal relation to changing creatures?

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- ATTRIBUTES: omnipotence
- eternity immutability

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- aseity omnipotence → logically possible acts; contradictions are not objects of power foreknowledge vs freedom → Boethius
- open theism goodness + power + knowledge + evil → joint compatibility pressure simplicity → no parts

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- essence = existence
- attributes not separable components objection: can identical attributes permit free, personal relation to changing creatures?

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Major criticism: The classical attributes generate pressure when unlimited power, complete foreknowledge, perfect goodness and creaturely freedom are asserted without qualification.

03

STAGE 03 SPINOZA: DEUS SIVE NATURA

DEUS SIVE NATURA · ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE · INFINITE EXPRESSION MODES · FINITE MINDS AND BODIES HUMANS KNOW THOUGHT AND EXTENSION · PERSONALITY, PROVIDENCE AND FREE WILL DISAPPEAR REPLY · SELF-DETERMINED ACTION FROM ONE'S OWN NATURE, NOT ARBITRARY CHOICE.

DEUS SIVE NATURA → ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE

ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression MODES: finite minds and bodies humans know Thought and Extension depend on → God does not choose to create radically immanent, not a personal ruler outside nature objection

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEUS SIVE NATURA → ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE
- ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression MODES: finite minds and bodies humans know Thought and Extension depend on the one substance

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- God does not choose to create radically immanent, not a personal ruler outside nature objection: personality, providence and
- DEUS SIVE NATURA → ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression MODES: finite minds and bodies humans know Thought and Extension depend on the one substance
- God does not choose to create radically immanent, not a personal ruler outside nature objection: personality, providence and

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza replaces a purposive creator with one necessary substance from whose nature every finite mode follows.

04

STAGE 04 ADVAITA: NIRGUṆA, SAGUṆA AND VIVARTA

NIRGUNA, SAGUNA AND VIVARTA · ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN · BEYOND LIMITING PREDICATES; PĀRAMĀRTHIKA; SAT-CIT-ĀNANDA · SAGUNA ĪSVARA · PERSONAL LORD; CREATOR/RULER; VYĀVAHĀRIKA; DEVOTION · BRAHMAN + MĀYĀ · EXPERIENCED WORLD THROUGH VIVARTA, APPARENT TRANSFORMATION ROPE APPEARS SNAKE · LIBERATION KNOWS AN ALREADY-EXISTING IDENTITY

ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN

NIRGUNA: beyond limiting predicates; pāramārthika; Sat-Cit-Ānanda → SAGUNA ĪSVARA: personal Lord; creator/ruler; vyāvahārika; devotion → Brahman + māyā → experienced world through VIVARTA, apparent transformation rope appears snake; Brahman undergoes

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN
- NIRGUNA: beyond limiting predicates; pāramārthika; Sat-Cit-Ānanda

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SAGUNA ĪSVARA: personal Lord; creator/ruler; vyāvahārika; devotion
- Brahman + māyā → experienced world through VIVARTA, apparent transformation rope appears snake; Brahman undergoes no real change

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ĀTMAN = BRAHMAN → liberation knows an already-existing identity
- TRAP: anirvacaniya properly marks māyā/world appearance, not nirguna Brahman itself.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Advaita applies indefinability to māyā and world-appearance, while nirguna Brahman remains the non-dual reality beyond limiting predicates.

05

STAGE 05 RĀMĀNUJA: ORGANIC UNITY

ORGANIC UNITY · PERSONAL SAGUNA BRAHMAN, NĀRĀYAṆA · CIT (SELVES) + ACIT (MATTER) · REAL QUALIFICATIONS OF BRAHMAN · WORLD/SOULS ARE BODY; BRAHMAN IS INDWELLING CONTROLLER · INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE WITHOUT NUMERICAL IDENTITY · MATERIAL AND EFFICIENT CAUSE; WORLD IS REAL PARIṆĀMA JĪVA · LIBERATION OBJECTION

VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA → personal saguna Brahman, Nārāyaṇa → CIT (selves) + ACIT (matter) = real qualifications of Brahman → ŚARĪRA-ŚARĪRĪ: world/souls are body; Brahman is indwelling controller → APRTHAK-SIDDHI: inseparable dependence without numerical identity → God = material and efficient cause

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA → personal saguna Brahman, Nārāyaṇa
- CIT (selves) + ACIT (matter) = real qualifications of Brahman
- ŚARĪRA-ŚARĪRĪ: world/souls are body; Brahman is indwelling controller

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- APRTHAK-SIDDHI: inseparable dependence without numerical identity
- God = material and efficient cause
- world is real PARIṆĀMA jīva → dependence → bhakti → prapatti → liberation objection: do bodily defects taint God?

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- reply: defects belong to controlled body.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Real manifestation/pariṇāma (real transformation); bhakti and prapatti; liberation is service/communion, not absorption.

06

STAGE 06 NYĀYA AND HINDU DIVINE PLURALITY

NYĀYA AND HINDU DIVINE PLURALITY · NYĀYA ĪSVARA · GOD + SELVES + ATOMS + SPACE/TIME ARE REAL · GOD IS EFFICIENT CAUSE; ETERNAL ATOMS ARE MATERIAL CAUSES · DIVINE COORDINATION · FITTING RESULTS; SELVES REMAIN DISTINCT · "IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" POLYTHEISM · ṚGVEDA 1.164.46

NYĀYA ĪSVARA: God + selves + atoms + space/time are real

God is efficient cause; eternal atoms are material causes karma/adṛṣṭa → divine coordination → fitting → "IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" polytheism → Ṛgveda 1.164.46: reality is one; sages speak of it variously verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NYĀYA ĪSVARA: God + selves + atoms + space/time are real
- God is efficient cause; eternal atoms are material causes karma/adṛṣṭa → divine coordination → fitting results; selves remain distinct

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- "IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" polytheism
- Ṛgveda 1.164.46: reality is one; sages speak of it variously verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise, sectarian supremacy and

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Upanisadic monism coexist; one label cannot exhaust all levels.
- NYĀYA ĪSVARA: God + selves + atoms + space/time are real

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: reality is one; sages speak of it variously verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise, sectarian supremacy and.

07

STAGE 07 COMPARATIVE GOD-WORLD-MAN MATRIX

COMPARATIVE GOD-WORLD-MAN MATRIX · SYSTEM GOD-WORLD GOD-MAN · THEISM CREATOR AND SUSTAINER WORSHIP, PROVIDENCE, GRACE · DEISM CREATOR WHO WITHDRAWS REMOTE RATIONAL SOURCE · SPINOZA GOD · NATURE PERSON IS FINITE MODE · ADVAITA WORLD IS VIVARTA ĀTMAN · RĀMĀNUJA WORLD IS GOD'S REAL BODY DISTINCT YET INSEPARABLY

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
SYSTEM GOD-WORLD GOD-MAN	Spinoza God = Nature person is finite mode	Nyāya God orders eternal atoms distinct soul under moral governance ultimate cause need not be physical: spatial/material dependence limits ultimacy
Theism creator and sustainer worship, providence, grace	Advaita world is vivarta ātman = Brahman	pantheism and Rāmānuja qualify this without requiring an anthropomorphic body.
Deism creator who withdraws remote rational source	Rāmānuja world is God's real body distinct yet inseparably dependent	

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- SYSTEM GOD-WORLD GOD-MAN
- Theism creator and sustainer worship, providence, grace
- Deism creator who withdraws remote rational source

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Spinoza God = Nature person is finite mode
- Advaita world is vivarta ātman = Brahman
- Rāmānuja world is God's real body distinct yet inseparably dependent

EVALUATION / TRAP

- Nyāya God orders eternal atoms distinct soul under moral governance ultimate cause need not be physical: spatial/material dependence limits ultimacy
- pantheism and Rāmānuja qualify this without requiring an anthropomorphic body.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God-models must be compared on common axes of world-relation, human freedom and worship, not by labels considered in isolation.

08

STAGE 08 EXAMINER TRAPS AND PYQ ROUTES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND PYQ ROUTES · SPATIALLY REMOTE IMMANENT · NON-EXISTENT APRTHAK-SIDDHI · NYĀYA GOD · EFFICIENT CAUSE · PYQ ROUTES PERSONAL/IMPERSONAL · THEISM + SPINOZA + SAGUṆA/NIRGUṆA · DEVOTION FREEDOM/GOD

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
TRAPS: personal != anthropomorphic	nirguna != non-existent apṛthak-siddhi != identity	PYQ ROUTES personal/impersonal → theism + Spinoza + saguna/nirguna
transcendent != spatially remote immanent != pantheistic	Nyāya God = efficient cause	Spinoza → substance → attributes → modes → necessity → criticism
pantheism != panentheism	monism != monotheism	Rāmānuja → cit/acit → body-soul → apṛthak-siddhi → devotion freedom/God → foreknowledge problem → named solutions → qualified verdict.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TRAPS: personal != anthropomorphic
- transcendent != spatially remote immanent != pantheistic
- pantheism != panentheism

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- nirguna != non-existent apṛthak-siddhi != identity
- Nyāya God = efficient cause
- monism != monotheism

EVALUATION / TRAP

- PYQ ROUTES personal/impersonal → theism + Spinoza + saguna/nirguna
- Spinoza → substance → attributes → modes → necessity → criticism
- Rāmānuja → cit/acit → body-soul → apṛthak-siddhi → devotion freedom/God → foreknowledge problem → named solutions → qualified verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A high-scoring comparison states each model's world-relation, tests its freedom or coherence problem and closes with a named, qualified verdict.

09

STAGE 09 ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION · DEFINE EXACT GOD-CONCEPT · STATE METAPHYSICAL MODEL · EXPLAIN GOD-WORLD AND GOD-MAN RELATIONS · USE EXACT SCHOOL TERMINOLOGY · STRONGEST OBJECTION · STRONGEST REPLY · SAME-AXIS COMPARISON

define exact God-concept → state metaphysical model → explain God-world and God-man relations → use exact school terminology → strongest objection → strongest reply → same-axis comparison → qualified philosophical verdict → God is a family of models: perfect person, infinite substance, non-dual consciousness, organic unity or

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- define exact God-concept → state metaphysical model
- explain God-world and God-man relations → use exact school terminology

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- strongest objection → strongest reply → same-axis comparison
- qualified philosophical verdict

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- God is a family of models: perfect person, infinite substance, non-dual consciousness, organic unity or intelligent ordering.
- Adequacy turns on nature + attributes + relations coherence: whether ultimacy best preserves agency, unity, devotion, independence, moral

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Final verdict: "The notion of God is not a single universal concept but a family of metaphysical models.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ENRICHMENT — EXTRA DEPTH, NEVER A PREREQUISITE FOR THE · WESTERN AND ABRAHAMIC REFERENCE STANDARDS · INDIAN SCHOOL-SPECIFIC COMPARISON · CRITIQUE, LANGUAGE AND PRACTICAL CONSEQUENCES · EXTERNAL PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION DOSSIER · TOPIC 1 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · CREATION EX NIHILO MEANS DEPENDENCE ON DIVINE AGENCY WITHOUT

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED / ENRICHMENT — extra depth, never a prerequisite for the verified PYQs
- Western and Abrahamic Reference Standards
- Indian School-Specific Comparison
- Critique, Language and Practical Consequences

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- External Philosophy of Religion dossier: Topic 1 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Creation ex nihilo means dependence on divine agency without independent primordial material; "nothing" is not a material cause.
- Emanation treats finite reality as proceeding from the source, often with stronger necessity and weaker choice.
- Panentheism places the world within divine life while holding that God exceeds it.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Efficient causation need not require physical manifestation.
- Ramanuja's body-language expresses dependence and governance, not a finite divine organism.
- Augustine: creator, eternal truth, goodness and providential personal relation.
- Anselm: perfect-being grammar; use its attribute implications here, not the proof.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels